

SENATE No. 2112

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Nick Collins

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to increased safety standards in the construction industry.

PETITION OF:

NAME:

Nick Collins

DISTRICT/ADDRESS:

First Suffolk

SENATE No. 2112

By Mr. Collins, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 2112) of Nick Collins for legislation relative to increased safety standards in the construction industry. State Administration and Regulatory Oversight.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to increased safety standards in the construction industry.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Notwithstanding any or special law to the contrary, the appropriate agencies of the
2 commonwealth shall develop regulations to increase standards that address safety issues in the
3 construction industry;

4 Area of review for regulations shall include but not be limited to the following:

5 Craft workers

6 • 40 hours of safety training by an approved training provider, with a 10-hour refresher
7 completed on an annual basis

8 Craft foreperson

9 • 62 hours of safety training by an approved training provider, with a 10-hour refresher
10 completed on an annual bases

Site safety manager licensing

- For any project over 50,000 square feet a Site Safety Manager is required to be on-site

at all times

- To be a site safety manager you must have:

(i) Minimum 5 years construction safety experience

(ii) 40 hours SSM course

(iii) Safety experience background check

(iv) Knowledge test: 80% correct to pass

(v) Physical exam for fitness

(vi) 3 year refresher

Concrete, steel, excavation, façade

- 62-hours of safety training by an approved training provider, with a 10-hour refresher

completed on an annual bases

Site safety and demolition plan review and enforcement

- Require major building and demolition projects to prepare and keep current a site safety plan. The plan, and subsequent updates, should be reviewed and approved by the Authority

Having Jurisdiction and is required to be on site for inspector review

Scaffolding

- 29 • Minimum requirements for the design, permitting, erection, maintenance, and
30 disassembly of supported and suspended scaffolds.
- 31 • Standards include stamped and filed drawings by a licenses design professional, use of
32 licensed master rigger for erection and dismantling of suspended scaffolds, worker training,
33 debris netting and scaffold access

34 Concrete formwork

- 35 • Minimum standards for the design, erection, and inspection of concrete formwork
- 36 • Site specific drawings to be prepared by registered design professional
- 37 • Engineered designs submitted for review/ approval and on site for inspectors

38 Protection of unenclosed perimeter façade

- 39 • Minimum requirements for perimeter protection prior to façade installation
- 40 • Permitted drawing by licensed design professional, requires vertical and horizontal
41 safety netting or better to be installed and maintained at all unenclosed perimeters

42 Enhancement of sidewalk shed public protection

- 43 • Minimum standards for the design, permitting, erection, inspection, and maintenance of
44 sidewalk shed including adjoining property protection
- 45 • Mandatory sidewalk sheds and site scaffolding for all projects in the Boston area

46 Inspection and enforcement

47 • Provide additional resources to inspection enforcement agencies to hold all General
48 Contractors to elevated safety standards

49 • These city and state workers who have the authority to inspect project for safety
50 compliance per the required documentation and permitting

51 Retain experienced inspectors

52 • Reclassify local building inspectors as Massachusetts public safety official to help
53 retain experienced experts in high-risk Boston environments